

STUDY-UNI · FULL MARKING SCHEME

MG2007

Enterprise Planning and Processes

Summer 2023 Examination · Paper 1

Duration: 90 minutes | **Total Marks:** 100

Instructions: Answer both Question 1 and Question 2 | each question: answer any 3 of 4 (50 marks)

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How This Marking Scheme Is Structured

Both questions on this paper ask you to answer **any three of four** options, each carrying equal marks. This scheme covers **all four options in both questions** so that whichever three you choose per question, a complete model answer is available.

This paper names several models covered on earlier sittings, but frequently pairs them with a **different application context** than before (for example, the Business Model Canvas is asked here against *business growth strategies* rather than organizational strategy generally, and Situational Leadership is asked against *operational effectiveness* rather than leadership-skills assessment). Where the context has changed, the model's description and purpose sections are necessarily similar to earlier sittings — the model itself has not changed — but the **critical application section has been rewritten specifically for this paper's named context**, since that is where marks for genuinely answering the question asked (as opposed to a memorised answer to a differently-worded question) are earned. The **7-S Framework** (Question 2(a)) is new to this sitting and has been built fresh.

Each sub-part is marked out of **16.7** ($50 \div 3$), reflecting one of the three answers you will select within that 50-mark question; UCC may allocate this as whole numbers (e.g. 17 + 17 + 16) at the point of aggregation, which does not change the underlying weighting.

CHECKNOTE — CITATION APPROACH *Every model in this scheme is grounded in its original, independently verifiable source (see the References line under each sub-part). Illustrative examples used to connect a model to its named context are drawn from generic, widely understood patterns and are flagged inline as independent reasoning rather than MG2007 course-pack content.*

Question 1 — Growth Strategy & Operational Effectiveness Models

Answer any three of the following four. Use examples to support your answer. All questions carry equal marks. (50 marks)

Question 1(a) — Ansoff Matrix

QUESTION AS SET

a. Critically discuss the **Ansoff matrix model** and its application in supporting business growth strategies of an enterprise.

FULL MODEL ANSWER

1. Description of the Model (≈40%)

The **Ansoff Matrix** was introduced by Igor Ansoff as a two-by-two framework for classifying the growth strategies open to a firm along two axes: **products** (existing vs. new) and **markets** (existing vs. new). The four resulting quadrants are:

- **Market Penetration** — selling more of an existing product into an existing market (e.g. through pricing, promotion, or increased usage). This is the lowest-risk quadrant.
- **Product Development** — launching new products into existing markets, drawing on established customer relationships and brand equity.
- **Market Development** — taking an existing product into a new market, whether a new geography, customer segment, or distribution channel.
- **Diversification** — new products into new markets. This is the highest-risk quadrant, since the firm has neither established product capability nor established market knowledge to draw on, and it is further split into *related* diversification (some synergy with the existing business) and *unrelated* diversification (none).

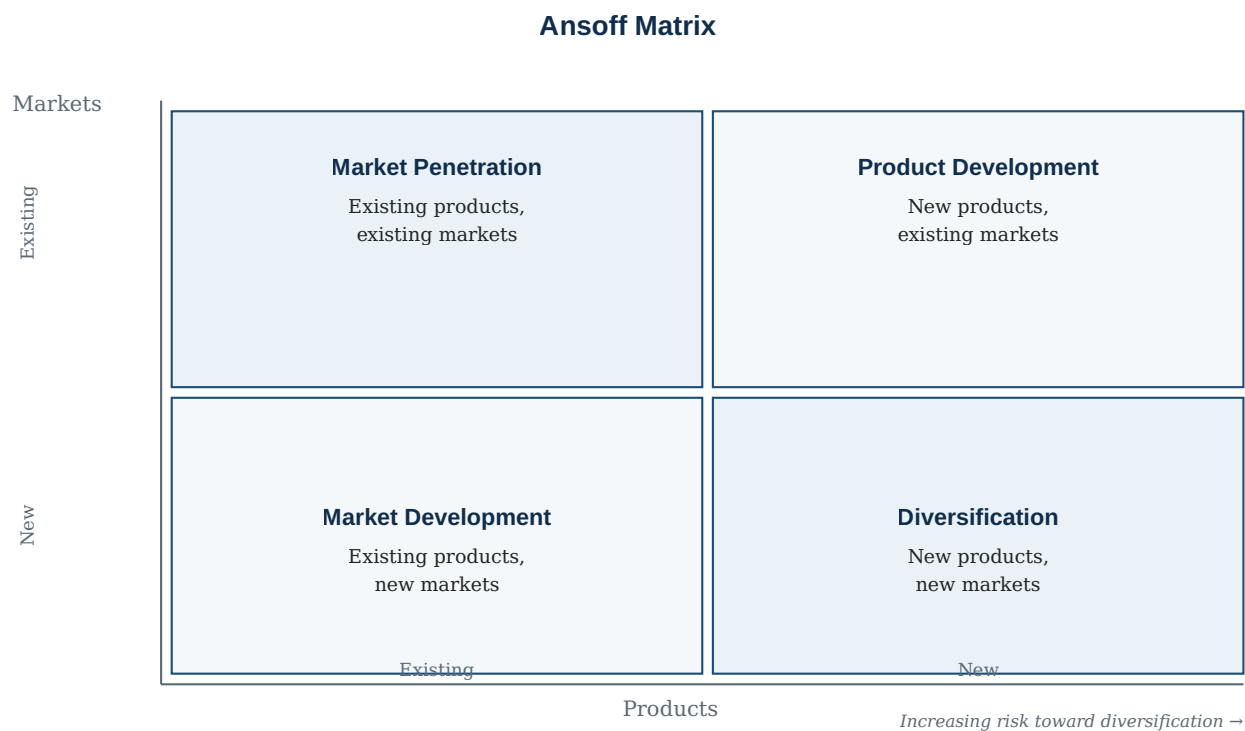


Figure 1 — The Ansoff Matrix, plotting product newness against market newness.

2. Purpose and Benefits

The model's purpose is to give management a structured vocabulary for growth options before committing resources, forcing an explicit choice between organic growth from what the firm already does well and riskier expansion into unfamiliar territory. Its main benefit is simplicity: it is quick to apply in a workshop setting, requires no financial modelling to use directionally, and creates a shared reference point across a management team debating strategic direction.

3. Critical Application — Organizational Strategy

Applied to organizational strategy, the Ansoff Matrix is most useful as a *screening* tool early in strategy formulation, not as a decision-making tool on its own. A consumer goods firm such as Coca-Cola, for example, uses market penetration in its core carbonated soft-drinks markets (promotional pricing, distribution intensity) while pursuing product development (new beverage lines) and market development (expansion into emerging markets) simultaneously across different parts of its portfolio — illustrating that large organizations rarely sit in a single quadrant at once.

CHECKNOTE — The Coca-Cola example above is used illustratively to show how the four strategies can be pursued in parallel across a diversified portfolio; it is not sourced from the MG2007 course pack and should be treated as independent grounding rather than lecture content.

Critically, the model has three well-recognised limitations that a strong answer should raise: (i) it says nothing about *how* to execute a chosen strategy, only which broad direction to pursue; (ii) it does not account for competitor response, so a market penetration move that looks safe on paper can trigger a price war that erodes the very margins it was meant to protect; and (iii) it treats risk as increasing uniformly toward diversification, when in practice a well-resourced related diversification (e.g. a beverage firm entering adjacent snack categories) can carry lower risk than an aggressive market development push into an unfamiliar regulatory environment. A critically strong answer therefore uses the

matrix to open the strategic conversation, then supplements it with tools that address competitive dynamics (Porter's Five Forces) and resource-fit (the 7-S framework) before a final strategic choice is made.

VERDICT Useful as a first-pass strategic screening tool; insufficient on its own to select or execute a growth strategy.

SOURCES CITED IN THIS ANSWER

Ansoff, H. I. (1957). Strategies for Diversification. *Harvard Business Review*, 35(5), 113–124.

Mark Allocation — Question 1(a)

Band	%	Marks	Criteria (per UCC MG2007 grade descriptors)
First Class 70–100%	70–100%	11.7– 16.7	All four quadrants correctly defined with clear existing/new product-market logic; diagram correct; purpose and benefit critically discussed; a genuine, well-grounded example applied to organizational strategy; at least two independently-sourced limitations raised with cogent argument (e.g. no treatment of competitor response, uneven risk gradient).
2.1 60–69%	60–69%	10.0– 11.5	Model correctly described with diagram; purpose clearly explained; application example present but less developed; at least one limitation raised without full independent grounding.
2.2 50–59%	50–59%	8.3–9.8	Model described with minor inaccuracies or an incomplete diagram; purpose stated but not linked clearly to organizational strategy; limited or generic critique.
Pass 40–49%	40–49%	6.7–8.2	Basic, mostly accurate description of the four quadrants; little independent application or critique; answer relies heavily on definitions without addressing the specific question asked.
Fail 0–39%	0–39%	0–6.5	Model misidentified or quadrants confused; no credible application to organizational strategy; no critical engagement.

Sub-part total

16.7 / 16.7 marks

Question 1(b) — Business Model Canvas

QUESTION AS SET

b. Critically discuss the **Business Model Canvas model** and its application in supporting business growth strategies of an enterprise.

FULL MODEL ANSWER

1. Description of the Model (≈40%)

The **Business Model Canvas (BMC)** is a one-page strategic management template that structures a business idea across nine interlocking building blocks: **Customer Segments**, **Value Propositions**, **Channels**, **Customer Relationships**, **Revenue Streams**, **Key Resources**, **Key Activities**, **Key Partners**, and **Cost Structure**. The right-hand side of the canvas (customer segments, value proposition, channels, relationships, revenue) addresses how the business creates and captures value for the customer; the left-hand side (key resources, activities, partners, cost) addresses how it is internally organised to deliver that value.

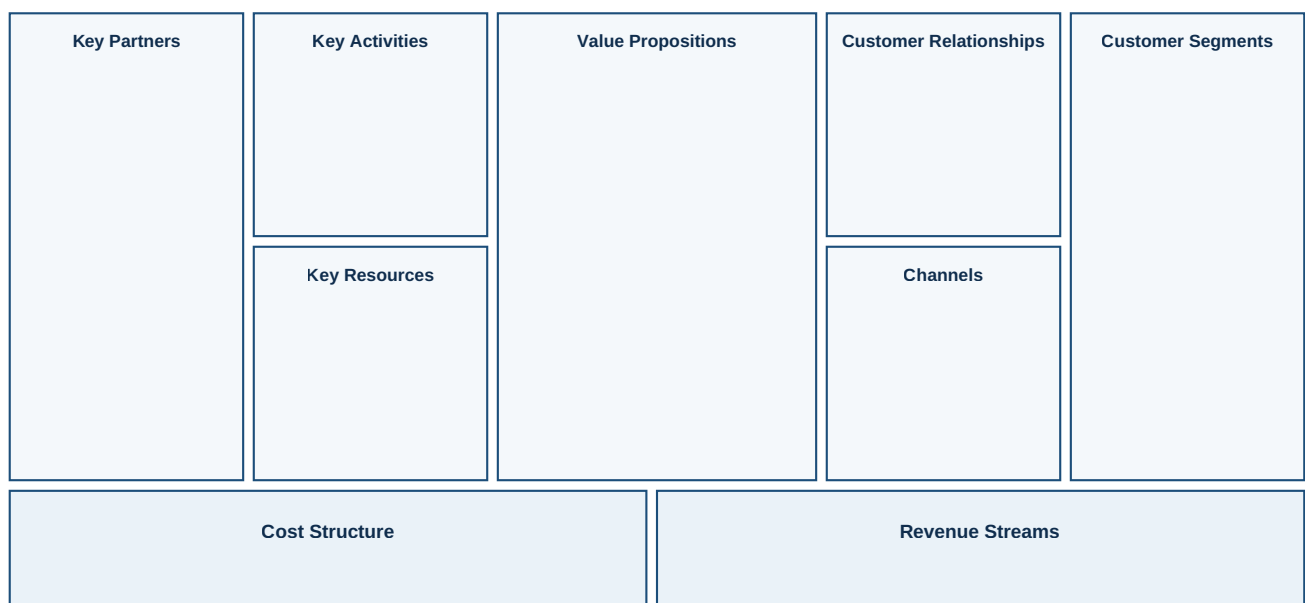


Figure 1 — The nine building blocks of the Business Model Canvas.

2. Purpose and Benefits

The model's purpose is to make the logic of a business model visible and debatable in a single view, rather than buried across a lengthy business plan. Its main benefits are speed of iteration — a team can sketch, test, and revise a business model in a workshop setting — and its function as a common language across otherwise siloed functions.

3. Critical Application — Business Growth Strategies

Applied to business growth strategies, the canvas is used to pressure-test how a proposed growth move would actually change the business model before resources are committed. Market development (taking an existing product into a new customer segment or geography) primarily stresses the Customer Segments and Channels blocks — can the existing Value Proposition genuinely travel, or does it need to be reworked? Product development stresses Key Activities and

Key Resources — does the firm actually have the capability to build and support a new offering? Used this way, the canvas complements a growth-strategy tool like the Ansoff Matrix: Ansoff tells management which broad growth direction is being considered, while the canvas forces them to work out concretely what has to change operationally to pursue it, and where the growth strategy might quietly break the existing business model.

CHECKNOTE — *The Ansoff/BMC complementarity described above is an analytical connection between two frameworks made for this answer; it is independent reasoning, not MG2007 course-pack content.*

Critically, the model's limitations should be raised: (i) it is qualitative and visual, so two versions of a canvas — the pre-growth business model and the proposed post-growth one — can look equally coherent on paper despite very different underlying unit economics, meaning the canvas alone cannot tell management whether a growth strategy is financially viable; (ii) it says nothing about competitive response to the growth move, so a market development canvas can look internally consistent while ignoring how incumbents in the new market will react; and (iii) building a canvas in a workshop can create a false sense that the team has agreed on the growth strategy, when in fact participants may have papered over real disagreement about what the value proposition actually is in the new context.

VERDICT A useful tool for making a growth strategy's operational implications concrete before committing resources; it needs to be paired with financial modelling and competitive analysis, since it cannot on its own validate whether a growth strategy is sound.

SOURCES CITED IN THIS ANSWER

Osterwalder, A. & Pigneur, Y. (2010). *Business Model Generation: A Handbook for Visionaries, Game Changers, and Challengers*. Hoboken, NJ: John Wiley & Sons.

Mark Allocation — Question 1(b)

Band	%	Marks	Criteria (per UCC MG2007 grade descriptors)
First Class 70–100%	70–100%	11.7– 16.7	All nine blocks correctly identified and explained; diagram correct; a coherent application to business growth strategy showing which blocks a specific growth move stresses; at least two independently-reasoned limitations (e.g. no financial or competitive lens, false workshop consensus).
2.1 60–69%	60–69%	10.0– 11.5	Most blocks correctly described; purpose explained; growth-strategy application present but under-developed; one limitation raised.
2.2 50–59%	50–59%	8.3–9.8	Partial or generic description of the nine blocks; limited link to growth strategy specifically; minimal critique.
Pass 40–49%	40–49%	6.7–8.2	Basic recall of some blocks; little independent application; answer does not clearly address growth strategy as asked.
Fail 0–39%	0–39%	0–6.5	Blocks confused with an unrelated framework or largely absent; no credible application.

Sub-part total

16.7 / 16.7 marks

Question 1(c) — EFQM Model

QUESTION AS SET

c. Critically discuss the **EFQM Model** and its application in supporting operational effectiveness of an enterprise.

FULL MODEL ANSWER

1. Description of the Model (≈40%)

The **EFQM Excellence Model** is a holistic management framework developed by the European Foundation for Quality Management, founded in the late 1980s by a group of leading European companies with support from the European Commission, with the first version of the model launched in 1991 as a pan-European alternative to national quality awards (subsequently revised, most recently in 2020). The model divides an organisation into **Enablers** — Leadership, People, Strategy, Partnerships & Resources, and Processes/Products/Services — which drive **Results** — People Results, Customer Results, Society Results, and overall Key Performance Results. An "Innovation and Learning" feedback loop runs from results back into the enablers, so that the model is intended to be continuously self-correcting rather than a one-off assessment.

ENABLERS

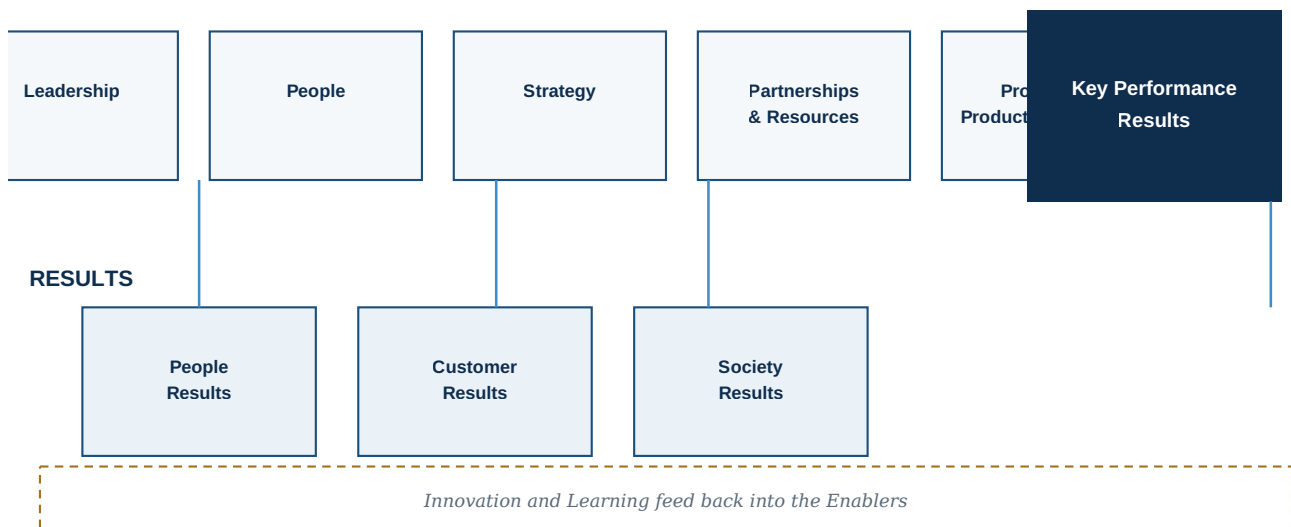


Figure 1 — Enablers driving Results, with feedback via innovation and learning.

2. Purpose and Benefits

The model's purpose is to provide organisations — profit and non-profit alike — with a common, externally benchmarkable structure for self-assessment, moving quality management beyond narrow product-inspection thinking toward a whole-organisation view of what drives sustainable performance. Its benefit is comprehensiveness: unlike narrower operational tools, it explicitly includes people and society results alongside financial/customer outcomes, which suits organisations (public bodies, universities, healthcare providers) for whom profit is not the only or even the primary success measure.

3. Critical Application — Operational Effectiveness

Applied to operational effectiveness, EFQM self-assessment is typically used by an organisation to score itself against each criterion (using EFQM's RADAR logic — Results, Approach, Deployment, Assessment and Refinement), identify the weakest-scoring enablers, and prioritise improvement projects there rather than spreading effort evenly across the whole organisation. It is widely used in European public-sector and healthcare bodies precisely because it does not assume a purely commercial success measure.

CHECKNOTE — *The description of RADAR logic and the public-sector/ healthcare adoption pattern goes beyond a bare definition of the model; it is grounded in EFQM's own published material rather than the MG2007 course pack specifically, and is flagged here for transparency.*

Critically, the model's limitations should be raised: (i) self-assessment against nine broad criteria is resource- and time-intensive, and smaller organisations often lack the administrative capacity to run it properly, which can turn the exercise into a box-ticking compliance activity rather than a genuine driver of change; (ii) because the criteria are broad and qualitative, scoring consistency between assessors can be weak without extensive assessor training, undermining the "benchmarkable" claim that is central to the model's value proposition; and (iii) unlike more operationally specific tools such as Six Sigma or Lean, EFQM identifies *where* performance is weak but provides comparatively little methodological guidance on *how* to fix it, meaning it is frequently used alongside, rather than instead of, more operationally prescriptive improvement tools.

VERDICT A strong diagnostic and benchmarking framework for whole-organisation performance; weak on prescribing the operational fix once a weakness is identified, and resource-intensive to run well.

SOURCES CITED IN THIS ANSWER

EFQM (European Foundation for Quality Management). *The EFQM Model*. Brussels: EFQM. (Foundation established 1988/89; first model published 1991, most recently revised 2020.)

Mark Allocation — Question 1(c)

Band	%	Marks	Criteria (per UCC MG2007 grade descriptors)
First Class 70–100%	70–100%	11.7– 16.7	Enablers and Results correctly identified with the feedback loop explained; diagram correct; RADAR logic or a comparable application mechanism discussed; at least two independently-reasoned limitations (e.g. resourcing burden, assessor consistency, weak prescriptive guidance).
2.1 60–69%	60–69%	10.0– 11.5	Enablers/Results correctly described; purpose explained; application to operational effectiveness present but under-developed; one limitation raised.
2.2 50–59%	50–59%	8.3–9.8	Partial or generic description of the model; limited link to operational effectiveness; minimal critique.
Pass 40–49%	40–49%	6.7–8.2	Basic recall that EFQM relates to quality/excellence; little independent application or critique.
Fail 0–39%	0–39%	0–6.5	Model misidentified or confused with an unrelated quality framework; no credible application.
Sub-part total			16.7 / 16.7 marks

Question 1(d) — Situational Leadership Model

QUESTION AS SET

d. Critically discuss the **Situational Leadership model** and its application in supporting operational effectiveness of an enterprise.

FULL MODEL ANSWER

1. Description of the Model (≈40%)

The **Situational Leadership Model**, originally published by Paul Hersey and Kenneth Blanchard as the "Life Cycle Theory of Leadership," argues that there is no single best leadership style; instead, effective leadership depends on the **readiness (or "maturity") level** of the individual or team being led. The model maps two behavioural axes — **directive behaviour** and **supportive behaviour** — into four leadership styles: **S1 Telling** (high directive, low supportive), **S2 Selling** (high directive, high supportive), **S3 Participating** (low directive, high supportive), and **S4 Delegating** (low directive, low supportive).

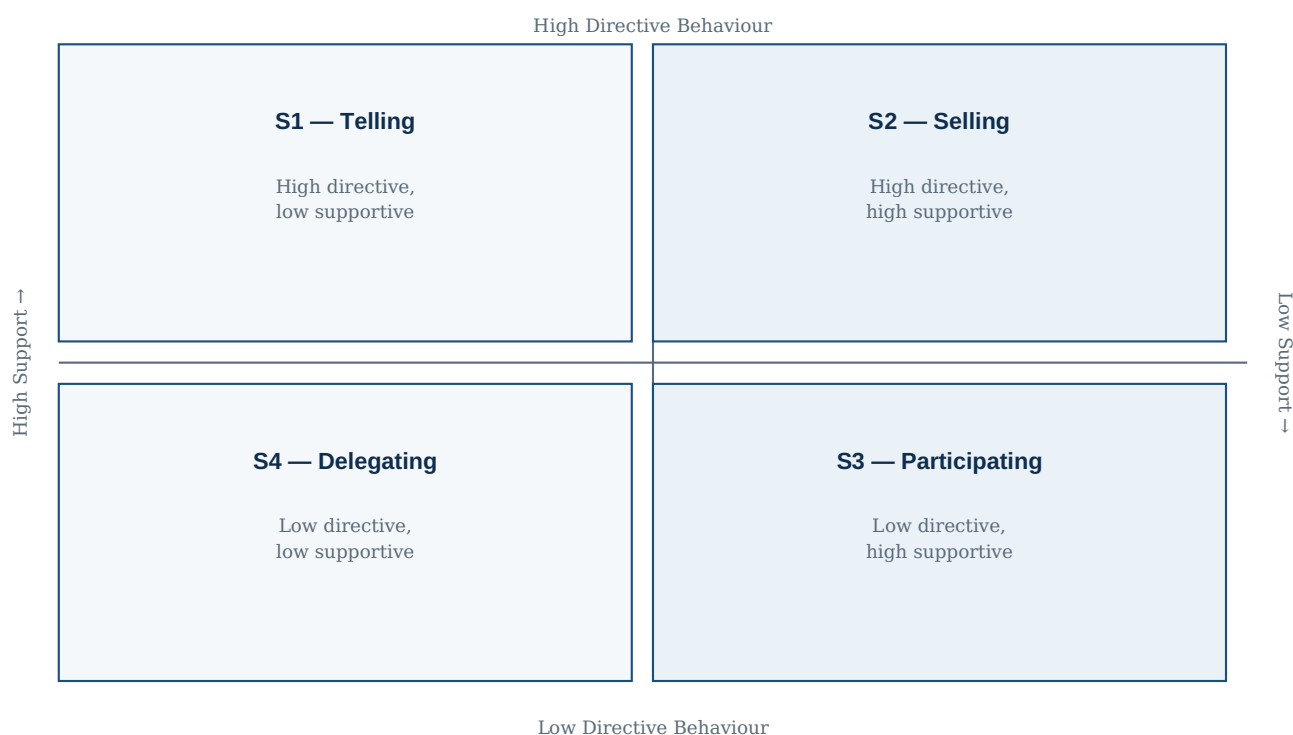


Figure 1 — The four leadership styles mapped against directive and supportive behaviour.

2. Purpose and Benefits

The model's purpose is to shift leadership away from a single "natural style" toward the flexibility to diagnose a follower's readiness and adapt accordingly. Its benefit is practical accessibility: the four-style structure gives managers a concrete, teachable vocabulary for a decision — how much direction versus autonomy to give — that directly shapes how well day-to-day work gets done.

3. Critical Application — Operational Effectiveness

Applied to operational effectiveness, style-task mismatches show up directly in operational metrics. A manager who "tells" an experienced, high-readiness team exactly how to perform a familiar process typically generates disengagement and slower throughput, since capable staff are being managed as if they were novices; a manager who "delegates" a genuinely new or high-risk task to a team that has not yet built the competence for it risks errors, rework, and missed deadlines. Under this model, operational effectiveness is improved not by picking a single "correct" management style organisation-wide, but by ensuring supervisors correctly diagnose readiness *per task* and flex their style accordingly — a new starter can be S1-appropriate on an unfamiliar process while being S4-ready on a task from their previous role.

CHECKNOTE — *The throughput/error-rate consequences described above are a generic illustration connecting style-task mismatch to operational outcomes; they are independent reasoning, not MG2007 course-pack content, and no specific measured effect size is asserted.*

Critically, the model's limitations should be raised: (i) "readiness" is inherently difficult to measure objectively on the shop floor or in an office setting, so its use as an operational-effectiveness diagnostic is often more subjective than the model's clean four-style structure implies; (ii) empirical research testing whether matching style to readiness actually improves measurable operational outcomes has produced mixed results, meaning the model's intuitive appeal outpaces its evidence base; and (iii) the model operates at the level of an individual manager-follower relationship and has little to say about operational effectiveness constraints that sit above that level — process design, systems, or resourcing — which is why it functions better as one input into operational effectiveness alongside process-focused tools rather than as a stand-alone operational diagnostic.

VERDICT

A useful lens for diagnosing whether day-to-day supervision style is helping or hindering operational output at the individual/team level; its evidence base is mixed, and it says little about the process, systems, and resourcing constraints that also drive operational effectiveness.

SOURCES CITED IN THIS ANSWER

Hersey, P. & Blanchard, K. H. (1969). Life Cycle Theory of Leadership. *Training and Development Journal*, 23(5), 26–34.

Mark Allocation — Question 1(d)

Band	%	Marks	Criteria (per UCC MG2007 grade descriptors)
First Class 70–100%	70–100%	11.7– 16.7	All four styles correctly mapped to directive/supportive axes and readiness levels; diagram correct; a coherent application connecting style-task match to operational outcomes (throughput, error rate, engagement); at least two independently-reasoned limitations (e.g. subjectivity of readiness, mixed empirical support, limited scope beyond the individual/team level).
2.1 60–69%	60–69%	10.0– 11.5	Most styles correctly described; purpose explained; operational-effectiveness application present but under-developed; one limitation raised.
2.2 50–59%	50–59%	8.3–9.8	Partial or generic description of the four styles; link to operational effectiveness weak; minimal critique.
Pass 40–49%	40–49%	6.7–8.2	Basic recall that leadership style should vary by situation; little independent application or critique.
Fail 0–39%	0–39%	0–6.5	Styles misidentified or confused with an unrelated leadership theory; no credible application.

Sub-part total

16.7 / 16.7 marks

Question 1 total (any 3 of 4 answered)

50 / 50 marks

Question 2 — Governance, Performance, Change & Innovation Models

Answer any three of the following four. Use examples to support your answer. All questions carry equal marks. (50 marks)

Question 2(a) — 7-S Framework

QUESTION AS SET

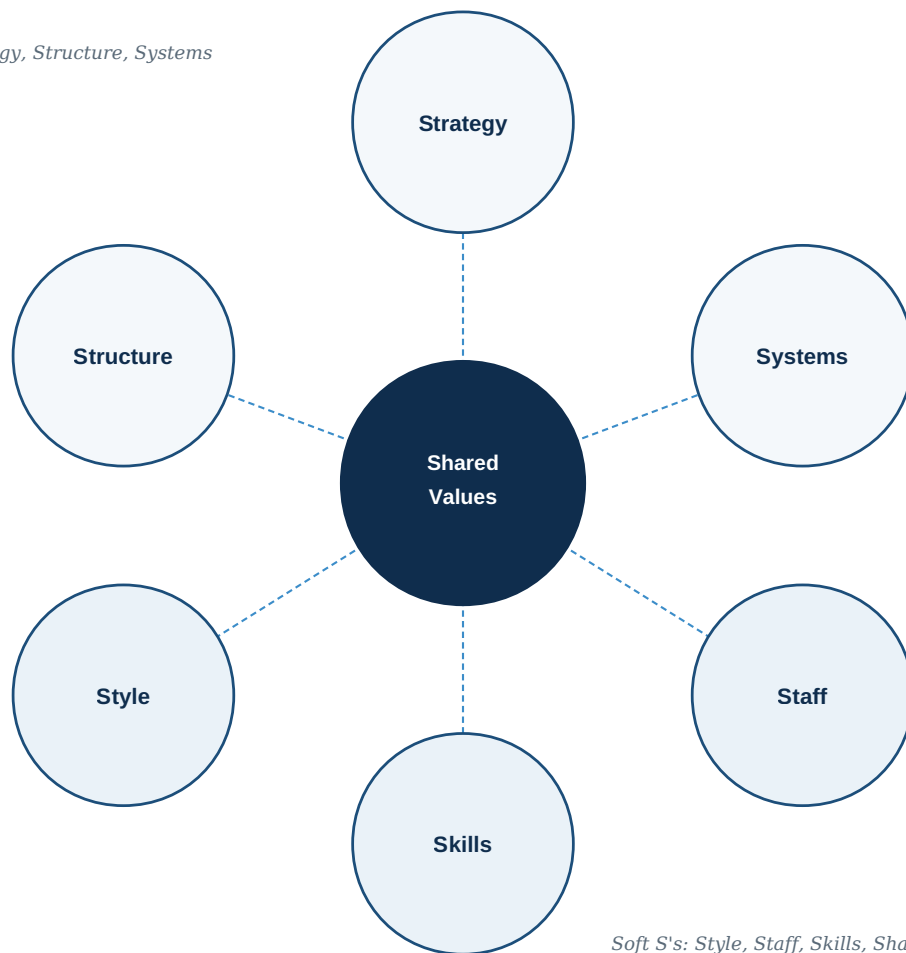
a. Critically discuss the **7-S Framework model** and its application in supporting governance effectiveness of an enterprise.

FULL MODEL ANSWER

1. Description of the Model (≈40%)

The **McKinsey 7-S Framework**, developed by Robert Waterman, Tom Peters, and Julien Phillips at McKinsey & Company, argues that organisational effectiveness depends on the alignment of seven interdependent elements, not on structure alone. Three "**hard**" elements — **Strategy** (the plan for building competitive advantage), **Structure** (how the organisation is divided and coordinated), and **Systems** (the formal processes and procedures that make the organisation run day to day) — are relatively easy to define and change. Four "**soft**" elements — **Shared Values** (the core beliefs and culture that sit at the centre of the model), **Style** (how management actually behaves, not how it says it behaves), **Staff** (the people and how they are developed), and **Skills** (the organisation's actual distinctive capabilities) — are harder to define and change, but the model's central claim is that they are just as decisive for effectiveness as the hard elements, and that all seven must be mutually reinforcing.

Hard S's: Strategy, Structure, Systems



Soft S's: Style, Staff, Skills, Shared Values

Figure 1 — The seven interdependent elements, with Shared Values at the centre connecting the three hard and four soft elements.

2. Purpose and Benefits

The model's purpose, as its title states directly, is to correct the assumption that reorganising the structure alone is sufficient to fix an underperforming organisation. Its benefit is a genuinely holistic diagnostic checklist: a change or governance initiative that only addresses structure while leaving staff capability, systems, or culture untouched is, under this model, addressing at most three of the seven elements that actually determine whether the organisation works.

3. Critical Application — Governance Effectiveness

Applied to governance effectiveness, the 7-S framework is useful precisely because governance failures are rarely pure structure failures. A board and reporting structure (Structure) can look textbook-correct on an org chart while governance remains ineffective because the systems for escalating risk information are weak (Systems), the values genuinely rewarded day to day tolerate cutting corners (Shared Values, Style), or the people staffing key oversight roles lack the specific skills to challenge management effectively (Staff, Skills). The framework's contribution to governance analysis is to force an audit of all seven elements rather than assuming a structural fix (adding a board committee, for example) is sufficient on its own.

CHECKNOTE — The governance-failure pattern described above (structure correct on paper, softer elements undermining it in practice) is a generic illustration of how the 7-S logic applies to governance; it is independent grounding, not MG2007 course-pack content, and no specific named company's governance failure is asserted here.

Critically, the model's limitations should be raised: (i) the "soft" elements — shared values, style, skills — are inherently difficult to measure objectively, so a 7-S review can identify that culture or style is a problem without providing much operational guidance on how to change it; (ii) the model treats the seven elements as needing mutual alignment but is comparatively silent on which element should lead a change effort or how to sequence intervention across all seven at once, which is where more process-focused tools (e.g. Kotter's eight-step model) offer more concrete guidance; and (iii) because it was developed to explain excellence in large, established corporations in the late 1970s, its assumption of a relatively stable set of "elements" sits less naturally with governance in fast-changing, loosely structured organisations such as early-stage ventures.

VERDICT

A strong corrective to structure-only thinking about governance effectiveness, forcing attention onto culture, systems, and capability alongside the org chart; weaker on prescribing exactly how to fix a misaligned soft element once identified.

SOURCES CITED IN THIS ANSWER

Waterman, R. H., Peters, T. J., & Phillips, J. R. (1980). Structure Is Not Organization. *Business Horizons*, 23(3), 14–26.

Mark Allocation — Question 2(a)

Band	%	Marks	Criteria (per UCC MG2007 grade descriptors)
First Class 70–100%	70–100%	11.7– 16.7	All seven elements correctly identified and split into hard/soft categories, with Shared Values correctly centred; diagram correct; a coherent application to governance effectiveness; at least two independently-reasoned limitations (e.g. soft elements hard to measure, weak sequencing guidance, dated assumption of organisational stability).
2.1 60–69%	60–69%	10.0– 11.5	Most elements correctly described; purpose explained; application to governance present but under-developed; one limitation raised.
2.2 50–59%	50–59%	8.3–9.8	Partial or generic description of the seven elements; hard/soft distinction unclear; minimal critique.
Pass 40–49%	40–49%	6.7–8.2	Basic recall that the model concerns more than just structure; little independent application or critique.
Fail 0–39%	0–39%	0–6.5	Elements misidentified or confused with an unrelated framework; no credible application.

Sub-part total

16.7 / 16.7 marks

Question 2(b) — Greiner's Growth Model

QUESTION AS SET

b. Critically discuss **Greiner's growth model** and its application in supporting organizational performance of an enterprise.

FULL MODEL ANSWER

1. Description of the Model (≈40%)

The **Greiner Growth Model**, developed by Larry Greiner, describes how organisations move through successive phases of **evolution** (stable growth under a consistent management style) and **revolution** (a crisis the current style cannot resolve, forcing structural change). The original 1972 model set out five phases — **Creativity** (ended by a leadership crisis), **Direction** (ended by an autonomy crisis), **Delegation** (ended by a control crisis), **Coordination** (ended by a red-tape crisis), and **Collaboration** — with a sixth phase added in Greiner's 1998 update. The model plots organisational size against age, with each evolutionary phase ending in a crisis that only a change in management practice can resolve.



Figure 1 — Evolution and revolution phases as an organisation grows, adapted from Greiner (1972).

2. Purpose and Benefits

The model's purpose is to show that the practices which drove growth in one phase become the very obstacle to further growth in the next, and that a "crisis" is a predictable feature of growth rather than a sign of managerial failure. Its benefit is diagnostic: a management team can identify which crisis it is actually facing rather than treating every symptom as an isolated operational problem.

3. Critical Application — Organizational Performance

Applied to organizational performance, Greiner's model explains why performance often degrades not because a firm is doing something new wrong, but because it is still doing something old right for too long. A firm that has outgrown its Creativity-phase informal coordination but has not yet installed Direction-phase systems typically shows the classic performance symptoms of a leadership crisis: missed deadlines, inconsistent quality, and founders becoming a bottleneck on every decision — not because staff are underperforming, but because the organisation's management practices have not kept pace with its size. Reading performance data through a Greiner lens therefore means asking which phase the organisation's practices are still calibrated for, rather than treating a performance dip purely as an execution problem to be solved within the current structure.

CHECKNOTE — *The leadership-crisis performance symptoms described above are a generic illustration connecting Greiner's phases to measurable performance strain; they are independent reasoning, not MG2007 course-pack content.*

Critically, the model's limitations should be raised: (i) it assumes a broadly linear growth trajectory, which understates how quickly some firms (particularly platform or digital businesses) can scale past several "phases" of practice almost simultaneously, making the model's stage-by-stage performance diagnosis less clean in practice; (ii) it explains *why* performance strain occurs at a transition but offers limited specific guidance on which management practices to install to resolve a given crisis; and (iii) using the model to explain a performance dip after the fact is easier than using it predictively, since real organisations rarely announce which phase they are in before the crisis actually hits.

VERDICT A strong explanatory lens for why performance strain recurs at predictable growth transitions; weaker as a predictive or prescriptive tool for exactly which management practices will resolve a given crisis before performance actually degrades.

SOURCES CITED IN THIS ANSWER

Greiner, L. E. (1972). Evolution and Revolution as Organizations Grow. *Harvard Business Review*, 50(4), 37–46. (Revised and reprinted with a commentary by the author in *Harvard Business Review*, 76(3), May–June 1998.)

Mark Allocation — Question 2(b)

Band	%	Marks	Criteria (per UCC MG2007 grade descriptors)
First Class 70–100%	70–100%	11.7– 16.7	All phases (five original, sixth noted) correctly described with the evolution/revolution logic explained; diagram correct; a coherent application linking a growth-stage mismatch to specific performance symptoms; at least two independently-reasoned limitations (e.g. non-linear scaling, weak prescriptive guidance, difficulty using the model predictively rather than retrospectively).
2.1 60–69%	60–69%	10.0– 11.5	Most phases and crises correctly described; purpose explained; performance application present but under-developed; one limitation raised.
2.2 50–59%	50–59%	8.3–9.8	Partial or generic description of phases; link to organizational performance not clearly explained; minimal critique.
Pass 40–49%	40–49%	6.7–8.2	Basic recall that the model concerns organisational growth stages; little independent application or critique.
Fail 0–39%	0–39%	0–6.5	Phases misidentified or confused with an unrelated lifecycle model; no credible application.
Sub-part total			16.7 / 16.7 marks

Question 2(c) — Eight-Step Change Model

QUESTION AS SET

c. Critically discuss the **Eight Phases of Change (Kotter) model** and its application in supporting organizational change of an enterprise.

FULL MODEL ANSWER

1. Description of the Model (≈40%)

The **Eight-Step Change Model**, developed by John Kotter following a ten-year study of over 100 companies attempting organisational transformation, sets out a sequential process for leading large-scale change: **(1) Establish a sense of urgency** around why change is needed now; **(2) Build a guiding coalition** with enough power and credibility to lead the effort; **(3) Form a strategic vision** that gives the change direction; **(4) Communicate the vision** repeatedly and through multiple channels; **(5) Empower broad-based action** by removing structural obstacles that block people from acting on the vision; **(6) Generate short-term wins** that are visible and unambiguous, to build momentum and credibility; **(7) Consolidate gains** and use the credibility from early wins to tackle bigger, harder change; and **(8) Anchor the new approaches in the culture**, so the change becomes "the way we do things around here" rather than reverting once attention moves elsewhere. Kotter's central argument is that skipping steps, or moving through them out of order, is the single biggest reason transformation efforts fail.

Create the climate for change

Implement and sustain change

Engage and enable the organisation

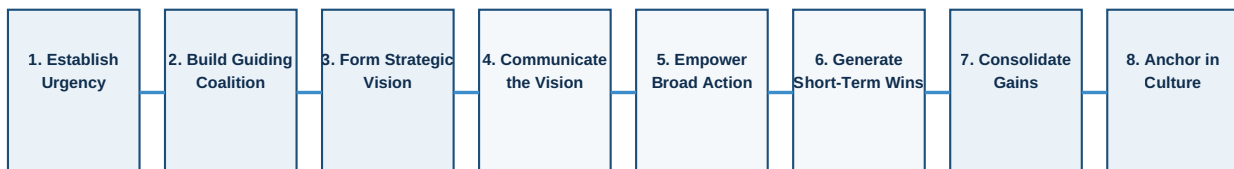


Figure 1 — Kotter's eight steps, grouped into three broad phases: creating the climate for change, engaging and enabling the organisation, and implementing and sustaining change.

2. Purpose and Benefits

The model's purpose is to give change leaders a sequenced process rather than a checklist of unordered good practices, on the argument — drawn directly from Kotter's original study — that the order matters as much as the individual steps: declaring victory after step 6 rather than pushing through to step 8, for example, is one of the specific failure patterns Kotter identified. Its benefit is that it is one of the most widely taught and recognised change models in management practice, giving change leaders a shared, easily communicated vocabulary for a process that is otherwise difficult to structure.

3. Critical Application — Organizational Change

Applied to organizational change, the model is typically used to sequence a change programme's early milestones: securing visible senior sponsorship and a burning-platform narrative (steps 1–2) before any detailed communication plan is built (steps 3–4), and deliberately engineering an early, unambiguous short-term win (step 6) — for example, a pilot site or business unit that visibly benefits from the change within the first few months — to build momentum for the harder, organisation-wide rollout that follows.

CHECKNOTE — *The pilot-site short-term-win illustration is a generic pattern used to make step 6 concrete; it is independent grounding, not MG2007 course-pack content.*

Critically, the model's limitations should be raised: (i) it is a strongly linear, top-down process, and Kotter himself has acknowledged it fits large, hierarchical organisations more naturally than flatter, more emergent ones where change is expected to arise bottom-up rather than be sequenced from the top; (ii) real organisational change rarely proceeds in eight discrete, non-overlapping steps — in practice, coalition-building and vision communication often have to run in parallel and be revisited repeatedly rather than being "completed" once, which the strict step ordering can obscure; and (iii) academic critique of the model notes that it is drawn almost entirely from Kotter's own consulting observations rather than from an independently replicated evidence base, meaning its authority rests substantially on its intuitive appeal and widespread adoption rather than on rigorous external validation.

VERDICT A well-structured, highly influential sequencing framework for top-down organisational change; less suited to emergent or bottom-up change, and its evidence base is drawn mainly from the author's own consulting observations rather than independent academic study.

SOURCES CITED IN THIS ANSWER

Kotter, J. P. (1995). Leading Change: Why Transformation Efforts Fail. *Harvard Business Review*, 73(2), 59–67.

Mark Allocation — Question 2(c)

Band	%	Marks	Criteria (per UCC MG2007 grade descriptors)
First Class 70–100%	70–100%	11.7– 16.7	All eight steps correctly sequenced and explained, with the three broad phases (climate, engagement, implementation) identified; diagram correct; a coherent application to organizational change; at least two independently-reasoned limitations (e.g. top-down bias, steps overlapping in practice, evidence base resting on the author's own consulting observations).
2.1 60–69%	60–69%	10.0– 11.5	Most steps correctly described in roughly the right order; purpose explained; application to change present but under-developed; one limitation raised.
2.2 50–59%	50–59%	8.3–9.8	Partial or generic description of the steps; sequencing logic not clearly explained; minimal critique.
Pass 40–49%	40–49%	6.7–8.2	Basic recall that change should be managed in stages; little independent application or critique.
Fail 0–39%	0–39%	0–6.5	Steps misidentified, incomplete, or confused with an unrelated change model; no credible application.
Sub-part total			16.7 / 16.7 marks

Question 2(d) — Stage-Gate Model

QUESTION AS SET

d. Critically discuss the **Stage-Gate model** and its application in supporting organizational innovation of an enterprise.

FULL MODEL ANSWER

1. Description of the Model (≈40%)

The **Stage-Gate Model**, developed by Robert Cooper, is a structured process for managing a new product from idea through to launch, breaking the journey into a sequence of **stages** — such as Discovery, Scoping, Building the Business Case, Development, Testing & Validation, and Launch — each followed by a **gate**: a go/kill decision point where a cross-functional review team assesses whether the project has met defined criteria to proceed, needs rework, or should be cancelled. Each stage involves parallel, cross-functional work (technical, marketing, and financial workstreams running concurrently rather than in a strict silo-to-silo handoff), while each gate acts as a quality-control checkpoint that commits progressively more resource to the project only as uncertainty is reduced.

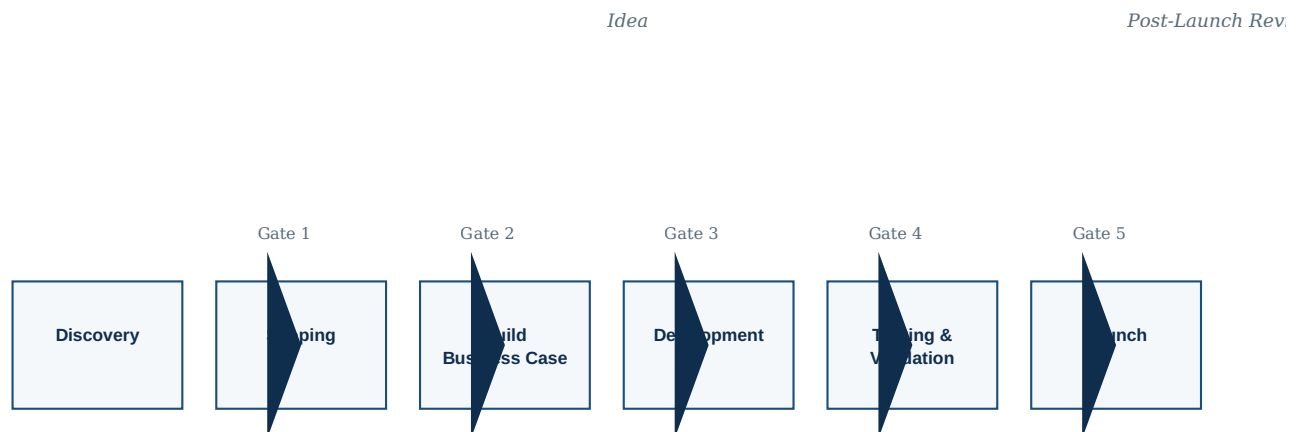


Figure 1 — Sequential stages separated by go/kill gates, from idea to launch.

2. Purpose and Benefits

The model's purpose is to reduce the historically high failure rate of new product development by preventing weak projects from consuming disproportionate resource simply because they were never formally reviewed and killed early. Its benefit is discipline: because each gate requires the project to clear defined criteria before more budget is committed, resource is concentrated on the strongest projects in the pipeline rather than spread thinly across every idea that was initially approved.

3. Critical Application — Organizational Innovation

Applied to organizational innovation, Stage-Gate is widely used in industries where product failure is expensive and hard to reverse post-launch — consumer packaged goods, pharmaceuticals, and industrial manufacturing are classic adopters, since a formal gate review before large-scale tooling or regulatory investment can prevent a costly late-stage

cancellation. Cooper's own later work notes that a majority of firms doing formal product development had adopted some version of the process by the 2000s, reflecting its broad industry uptake.

CHECKNOTE — The industry-adoption pattern (CPG, pharma, manufacturing) is grounded in Cooper's own published commentary on Stage-Gate's uptake rather than in the MG2007 course pack specifically, and is flagged here for transparency; no precise current adoption percentage is asserted.

Critically, the model's limitations should be raised: (i) a rigid, heavily bureaucratic gate process can slow down exactly the kind of fast, iterative experimentation that digital and software-based innovation depends on, which is why many technology firms have moved toward more agile, iterative development approaches instead of a strict linear stage-gate sequence; (ii) gate criteria are set in advance and can be gamed — project teams learn what a gate committee wants to see and present a case optimised to pass the gate rather than one that reflects the project's true risk; and (iii) because each gate is a discrete go/kill decision, promising but unconventional ideas that do not fit neatly into standard evaluation criteria at an early gate can be killed prematurely, before the market opportunity has had a chance to become legible.

VERDICT An effective discipline for capital-intensive, failure-costly innovation; poorly suited on its own to fast-iterating digital innovation, where firms increasingly blend it with agile methods (an "Agile-Stage-Gate" hybrid) rather than applying it in its original linear form.

SOURCES CITED IN THIS ANSWER

Cooper, R. G. (1990). Stage-Gate Systems: A New Tool for Managing New Products. *Business Horizons*, 33(3), 44–54.

Mark Allocation — Question 2(d)

Band	%	Marks	Criteria (per UCC MG2007 grade descriptors)
First Class 70–100%	70–100%	11.7– 16.7	Stages and gates correctly described with the go/kill review logic explained; diagram correct; a coherent application to organizational innovation with a credible industry context; at least two independently-reasoned limitations (e.g. rigidity versus agile innovation, gate criteria being gamed, premature killing of unconventional ideas).
2.1 60–69%	60–69%	10.0– 11.5	Stages/gates correctly described; purpose explained; application to innovation present but under-developed; one limitation raised.
2.2 50–59%	50–59%	8.3–9.8	Partial or generic description of the process; gate function not clearly explained; minimal critique.
Pass 40–49%	40–49%	6.7–8.2	Basic recall that new products move through stages; little independent application or critique.
Fail 0–39%	0–39%	0–6.5	Stages/gates misidentified or confused with an unrelated process model; no credible application.

Sub-part total

16.7 / 16.7 marks

